

PHP 5.3.0 released

The PHP development team has released PHP 5.3.0, a major improvement in the 5.X series, which includes a large number of new features and bug fixes. Some of these include: support for namespaces; late static binding; Lambda Functions and Closures; syntax additions; performance improvements and optional garbage collection for cyclic references. Other additions are: optional mysqlnd PHP native replacement for libmysql; more consistent float rounding; deprecation notices now handled via `E_DEPRECATED` (part of `E_ALL`) instead of the `E_STRICT` error level; several enhancements to enable more flexibility in `php.ini` (and `ini` parsing in general); new bundled extensions like `ext/phar`, `ext/intl`, `ext/fileinfo`, `ext/sqlite3`, `ext/enchant`; and over 140 bug fixes and improvements to PHP, in particular to: `ext/openssl`, `ext/spl` and `ext/date`. For users upgrading from PHP 5.2, consult the migration guide available at php.net/migration53.

Python 3.1 enhancements

June 27 saw the release of a new version of the backwards-incompatible series of Python 3. Improvements in Python 3.1 include: an ordered dictionary type; various optimisations to the `int` type; new unit-test features including test skipping and new assert methods; a much faster `io` module; tile support for Tkinter; a pure Python reference implementation of the `import` statement; new syntax for nested with statements. For more details check out the *What's new* document at docs.python.org/3.1/whatsnew/3.1.html.

Launchpad source code released

Canonical, the entity behind the Ubuntu project, has open-sourced the code that runs Launchpad under version 3 of the GNU Affero General Public License (AGPLv3). Launchpad is used to build Ubuntu and thousands of other projects, and its users can now participate directly in the development of Launchpad itself.

Launchpad allows developers to host and share code from many different sources using the Bazaar version control system, which is integrated into it.



Translators can collaborate on translations across many different projects. End-users identify bugs affecting one or more projects so that developers can then triage and resolve those bugs. Contributors can write, propose, and manage software specifications. In addition, Launchpad erases barriers to collaboration by enabling people to support

each other's efforts across different project hosting services, both through its Web interface and its APIs. Launchpad has everything software projects, open source or not, need to be successful.

Canonical founder and CEO, Mark Shuttleworth, said: "Projects that are hosted on Launchpad are immediately connected to every other project hosted there in a way that makes it easy to collaborate on code, translations, bug fixes and feature design, across project boundaries. Rather than hosting individual projects, we host a massive and connected community that collaborates together across many projects. Making Launchpad itself open source gives users the ability to improve the service they use every day."

Technical details about the open sourcing of Launchpad can be found on the Launchpad development wiki at dev.launchpad.net.

Airtel and HTC introduce Android-powered phone in India

Bharti Airtel and HTC Corporation have launched India's first Android-powered mobile phone, the HTC Magic. (Turn to Page ____ to read a review of Magic.)

For Airtel customers, HTC Magic allows free data download of 100 MB per month for a period of six months. The HTC Magic will be available at a market price of Rs 29,900 at Airtel relationship centres and authorised HTC resellers across 17 cities. The cities include Delhi, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Chennai, Hyderabad, Kolkata, Pune, Ahmedabad, Chandigarh, Jaipur, Coimbatore, Cochin, Ludhiana, Jalandhar, Lucknow, Bhubaneswar and Patna.

To begin with, Airtel customers can avail utility-based applications such as Portfolio Manager, Hello Tunes Manager, Weather Channel, Mobshare, In-mobile Search and City Search on the HTC Magic.

